

Designed by VICTORIA WANG

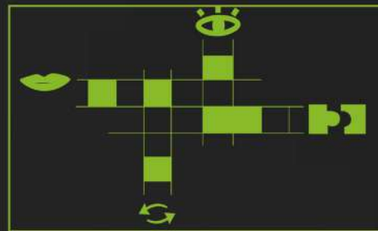
If a person realizes that each of her days is just another night, that her two eyes are equal to one of others' eyes, then she will strive for the true day, and this day will bring her a complete awakening, a complete awakening from the awakening, when everything is far clearer than when she was awake.

For the digital version, please visit: https://victoria-wang.itch.io/julia
For the introduction video, please visit: https://youtu.be/hTYDAoB8uUA

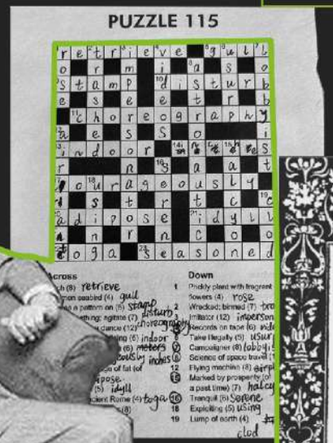
INSPIRATION

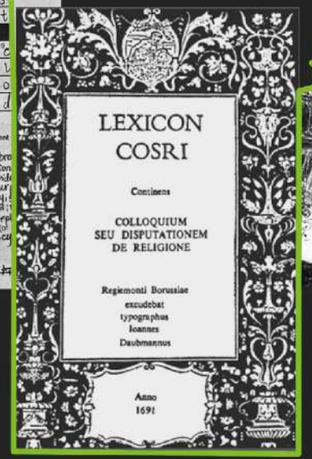
The game is inspired by many things. Contains elements of puzzles, mazes, language, surreal and many more. Includes aspects of plot, mechanics, and art style.

GAME MECHANICS



Crossword puzzles, commonly found in newspaper centrefolds, transform words into a vehicle for puzzle-style play, and the story of the Tower of Babel alludes to the natural properties of language as a riddle. Inspired by the collection of words as the primary gameplay for solving puzzles.













PLOT



Both Borges' work and Dictionary of the Khazars organise their plots in a labyrinthine narrative that allows a story to vary according to the reader's choices.This feature coincides with the game's branching choices. The narrative is inspired by the use of fragmented narratives centred on words.

ART STYLE

The collage art and montage techniques fit the fragmentary, stream-of-consciousness narrative mode, giving people a psychedelic, psychological feeling between the virtual and the real, which fits the theme of the game. Therefore, collage and montage are chosen as the main art style of the game.



SUMMARY

SYNOPSIS

You awaken from a dream, realizing you have lost all your memories. However, you distinctly remember there is an important task to accomplish. You find yourself in a labyrinthine dream, where the vocabulary serves as a compass to guide your direction.



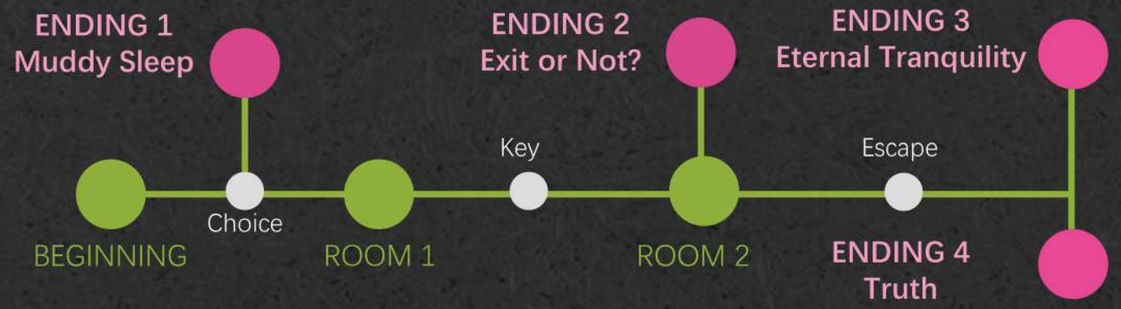








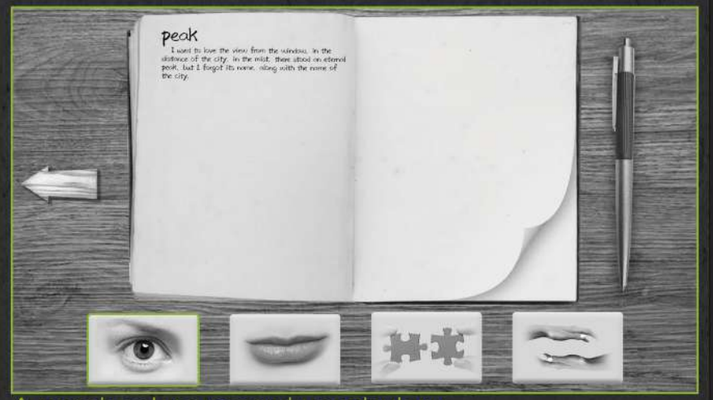
Collect vocabulary in the room and use the notebook's vocabulary conversion function to get new vocabulary. New vocabulary can spawn new items, or you can place them on the clue board to get new clues. Find a way out of the room and look for memories.



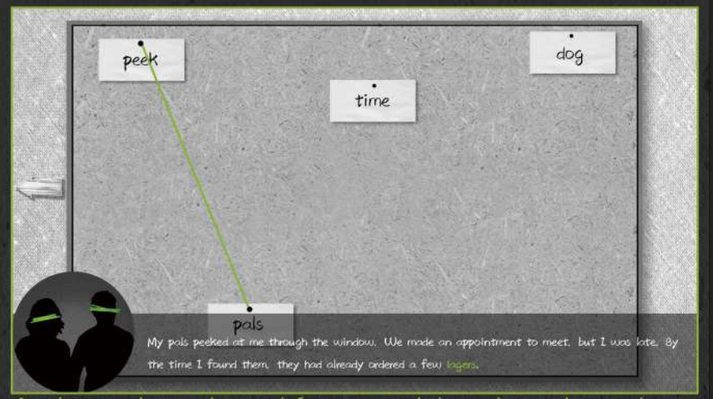


Ultimately, the time has come for a decision. Will you choose to escape, or... confront the truth?

UI DESIGN



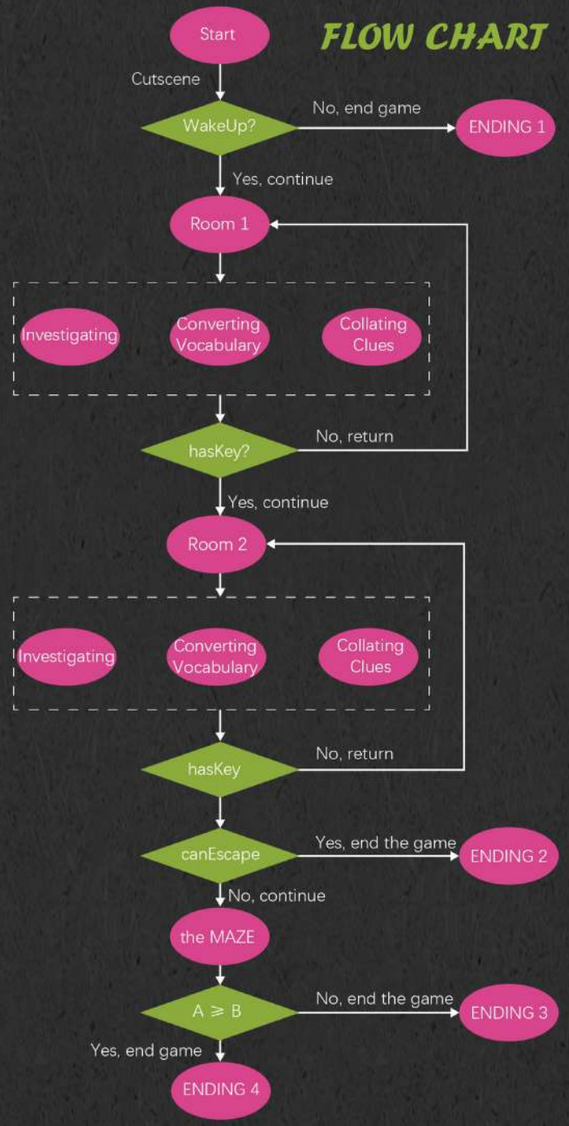
A notebook to record vocabulary.
Four workbenches for converting words.



A pin-up board used for organizing thoughts, where the correct connection of vocabulary can yield new information.

SYNOPSIS

FLOW CHART



PLOTS

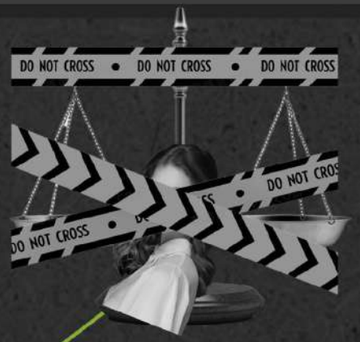


A woman who has lost all her memories wakes up in her room and the only thing she remembers is that she is a writer. Will she choose to find the truth, or will she wait for this nightmare to pass?



ENDING 1

She decided to wait for the nightmare to pass and closed her eyes again. But was it really just a nightmare? Would it ever end? In any case, she would never dream again.



ENDING 3

She woke up, completely. She finished it all. A perfect ending. Good had spoken, evil had been brought to justice, it was over, and peace had truly returned to her life.



She recalled something light, pleasant, and sweet. Life with her mother as a child, parties with friends, her writing career, or a man .....



In clues deep beneath the surface, she thought of more. Something dark and frightening emerged, and she remembered what she was looking for, didn't she?

ENDING 4

A perfect dream or a brutal truth? She was a woman of courage, always choosing the tougher one. the title of the book Now, no matter how the plot will unfold, the curtain has fallen on the drama that belonged to her. The truth is always the same, and the good thing is, both she and you can rest.



ENDING 2

Finally, she found the key to the door. It was an exit back to a peaceful life, and she walked out and lived as she always had, nothing had changed. Except, is that all there is to the story?



UI DESIGN

THE ROOM



The main investi-gation area will be presented as a room, and objects in the room can be interacted with by clicking on them.

Some scenarios have small scenes that can be investigated. Click on an object to zoom in, and click on a blank space to return to the room scene when you're done investigating.





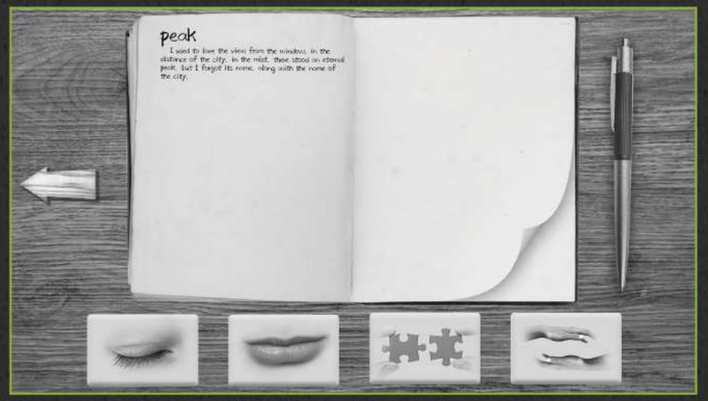


Left and right arrows switch room scenes.



Investigable objects will show a green outline line.

THE NOTEBOOK



The vocabulary words collected from the survey will appear in a notebook. The four workbenches at the bottom allow you to convert words to get new words.



This workbench converts words into words with similar spelling.



This workbench converts words into words with similar pronunciations.



This workbench combines or splits words.



This workbench reverses the spelling of words.

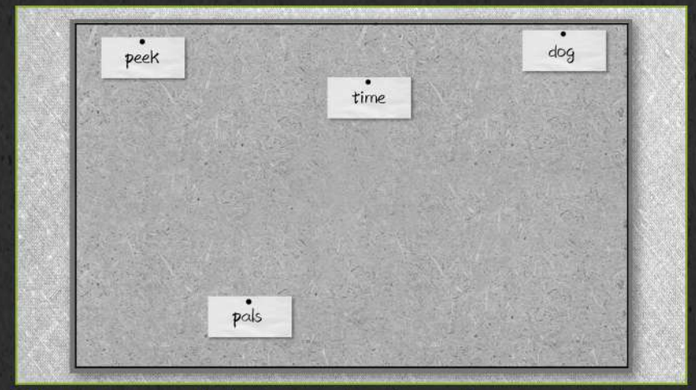


Drag words to the workbench to convert them.



Click on the folded corners to turn the page.

THE PIN-UP BOARD

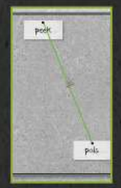


Words that are linked to each other will automatically appear on the board.



Click on two words to connect them, and if there is a link between them, a connecting line will appear on the board.

Click on an existing link to view the contents of the clue corresponding to the link.





When new clues appear, a dialogue bar appears at the lower end of the board, and new vocabulary found is highlighted in green and recorded into the notebook.

DIAGRAM

GLOSSARY

peak	peek	pique		
peek		pique		keep
time		Thyme	timetable	emit
diary	dairy			
dairy	daily			
dessert(s)	desert			stressed
drawer				reward
laptop			lap\top	
top				pot
keyboard			key\board	
plug				gulp
flower		flour		
write	white	right		
...				

PROCESS FLOW



Click on an object to interact with it.



The collected word will appear in a notebook.



Drag the word into the tool-bench to get a new word.



Some new words may appear on the clue board and connecting related words will result in new clues or words.



New clues or words will appear in the notebook.



Sometimes, new words are accompanied by new interactable objects in the room.

DEVELOPMENT

SYSTEM DESIGN



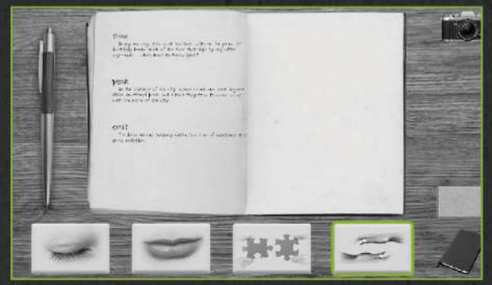
The settings include volume, sound effects and achievements.



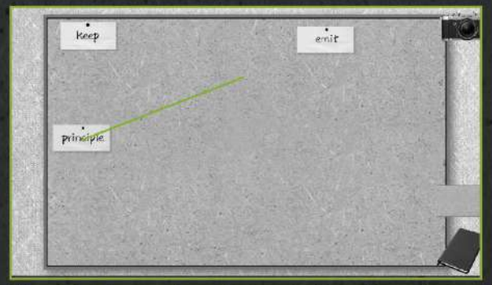
The save system has 6 slots, and the 1st slot is the default new save.



The scene system includes 6 switchable scenes.



The word collection system includes a notebook and workbenches.



The clue board and connecting lines feature have been implemented.



The guide, hints, and achievement system.

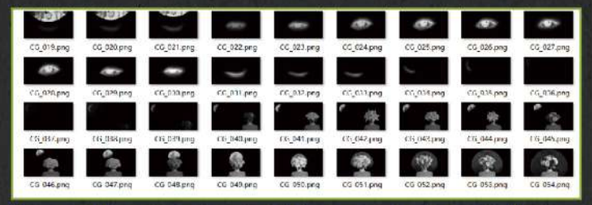
ART AND COPYWRITING

The art style adopts a collage approach to evoke a sense of surrealism. To indicate that the protagonist is deceased, black-and-white visuals are employed. All art assets are created using Photoshop.





The opening animation is created using frame-by-frame animation, approximately 140 frames, all of which are assembled using Photoshop collages.



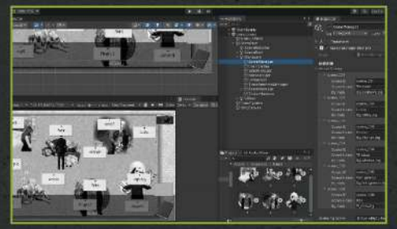
Due to the game's use of fragmented storytelling, copywriting becomes difficult. Ultimately, a complete story is constructed by listing items and words one by one to establish connections.

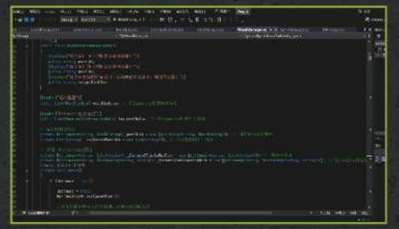




PROGRAMING

The program part is developed using the Unity engine and uses AI-assisted programming.





FEEDBACK

After finishing the demo, invite some friends from different backgrounds to try it out and give feedback.



Hemiit E.C.(Game Developer)

It is recommended to increase the opacity of the dialogue box and darken its color (make it less transparent) to avoid background scenes interfering with the visual recognition of text. It is also suggested to add interactive animations, such as various feedback when dragging and placing items.



Chocolate002(Visual Novel Enthusiast)

I like this story and its art style, but the positive feedback it gives me is a bit weak. I hope there could be more collecting or interactions to let me know I'm making progress in the game.



Winter Feast(Puzzle Game Enthusiast)

I like the design of the connection board and the word puzzle games at the end. I hope there can be more similar mini-games. Some word combinations are too difficult, maybe adding some hints would be better.